

G

Genius, as *ingenium*



Andrés Vélez Posada
Universidad EAFIT, Medellín, Colombia

Related Topics

Mind · Embodiment · Craftsmanship ·
Genius · Labor · Difference · Human
diversity · Understanding · Aesthetics ·
Epistemology · Natural philosophy · Politics of
knowledge

Synonyms

[Acuity](#); [Cunning](#); [Generation](#); [Ingenuity](#);
[Invention](#); [Mental capacity](#); [Nature](#); [Productivity](#);
[Talent](#); [Wit](#)

Introduction

The early modern period was an age of ingenuity. Well before the modern cults of personality and the Enlightenment and Romantic concept of outstanding “original genius”—roughly understood as the exceptional, unruly creative artist (Lecointe 1993; Brann 2002) – the notion of *genius* was bound to the meanings, practices, and representations of *ingenium*. Beyond its pithiest definition as an “innate property,” *ingenium* expressed early moderns’ attention to the differential singularity and distinguishing traits that

characterize a being. Although it was mainly used to understand the variety of human skills and intellectual capacities, *ingenium* could also designate any generative process produced by nature or technical means. Through the lens of *ingenium*, accounts of *genius* appear rather naturalized, leaning toward physiological, earth-bound, contextual, and moral explanations (Vélez Posada 2015).

The Language of Ingenuity

Ingenium was a capacious and dispersed notion, and it was expressed in so many different forms during early modernity that it is hard to accurately synthesize it (Zilsel 1926, 251). Derived from the Latin verb *gignere* (to produce, to beget), *ingenium* indicates a generation from within: a meaning enabling associations between invention, understanding, and labor with sexuality, pregnancy, and fertility. Linked to this original sense, *ingenium* was received by early moderns as a perceived vivacity, an externalized power which attracts attention and gives recognition to persons, works of art, places, and nations. It is possible to see this representation of *ingenium* in several emblems from the period (Marr et al. 2019). As the much-quoted pseudo-Virgilian verse says, *vivitur ingenio, caetera mortis erunt*: one lives on by *ingenium*, the rest belongs to death (Fig. 1). But, besides expressing the ideas of surviving fame and living force of the



Genius, as *ingenium*, Fig. 1 *Vivitur Ingenio, caetera mortis erunt.* The leaning skeleton, a plate arguably made by Jan van Calcar for the editio princeps of Andreas Vesalius, *De humani corporis fabrica libri septem*, Basel: Joannes Oporinus, 1543, p. 164. *Ingenium*, understood as “spirit,” talent, or ingenuity stood in opposition to the death of the human body. (<https://wellcomecollection.org/works/s7c87m8m>)

spirit, *ingenium* was also related to life in a more embodied sense. On the one hand, intellectual powers thrive when tested by need, difficulties, and problems – as illustrated by the story of the thirsty crow who throws little stones in a jar to raise the level of water (Fig. 2). On the other hand, the obstacles of material needs are also considered the exhausting burden of human invention – the wings of ingenuity are hindered by concerns, terrestrial limitations, and bodily conditions (Fig. 3). In addition, the language of ingenuity was directly concerned with penetration and sharp discernment. In one of the most influential emblematic personifications of *ingegno* during the period, Cesare Ripa described it as a young archer with iridescent wings, wearing a helmet with an eagle.

For Ripa, the act of pointing with the bow and the arrow represents the force and sharpness of human ingenuity, required for investigating celestial, terrestrial, and underground things (Fig. 4).

Ingenium – with its living, embodied, material connotations – was expressed in a vast network of vernacular words. While the French *engin* and English *engine* were mostly restricted to the domains of engineering and military artifacts, the senses of intellectual disposition, invention, and natural temper that *ingenium* also conveyed were infused in the French *esprit*, as well as in the English *wit* and *ingenuity*. *Ingenium* was also present in the Spanish *agudeza* and *ingenio*, Italian *ingegno* and *eloquenza*, Portuguese *engenho*, Dutch *vernunft* and *geest*, and German *Kopf* and *Gemüt* (Marr et al. 2018). When following the extraordinary web of words, meanings, and practices that this notion elicited in European languages, there is no doubt ingenuity was perceived as a socially distributed, plural, and relational phenomenon, so pervasive and presumed that “*ingenium* had become a whole empire” (Goodey 2011).

As hundreds of portraits, emblems, and eulogies from this period illustrate, ingenuity was a token of social reputation and self-fashioning (Fig. 5). The terminology of ingenuity was used to name a creative and clever ability perceived in the making of a work and through a prudent or gracious behavior, a subtle investigative capacity, or a witty way of speaking and writing. In seventeenth-century English, for instance, “ingenuity” and “ingenious” were closely connected with the moral sense of “ingenuousness” and “ingenuous.” Royal Society’s *Philosophical Transactions*, published since 1665, was presented from its title page as an “account of the present undertakings, studies, and labours of the ingenious in many considerable parts of the world.” By calling themselves “ingenious,” members of the Royal Society not only put forward their commitment in pursuing knowledge but were publicizing their work and methods as noble, free, honest, and trustworthy (Marr 2015; Shapin and Shaffer 1985, 131). Ingenuity, as Baltasar Gracián put it in *El Héroe* (1637, III), was both the sun and the lightning of this world.



Genius, as *ingenium*, Fig. 2 *Ingenii largitor venter*. The emblem, engraved by Crispin de Passe the Elder, paraphrases Persio's words: the stomach, master of arts, sharpens ingenuity ("Magister artis ingenique largitor, venter" in *Satirae*). A reference to guts, hunger, and need as being propitious for awakening wit. Gabriel Rollenhagen, *Nucleus emblematum selectissimorum*, Cologne, 1611. (<https://archive.org/details/nucleusemblematu00roll/page/n155>)

But if ingenuity could be the source of virtuous achievements, it was equally identified as the cause of deceit and trickery by means of shrewdness and cunning sharpness. In that sense, Spanish *ingenio* was not far from *engaño*, scam (a couple also found in Italian *ingegno-inganno*).

Juan Luis Vives was one of the earliest theoreticians to conceive of *ingenium* as a bodily, living process. He proposed a medico-philosophical interpretation of human ingenuity which was silently appropriated by many others during the sixteenth century, like the Spanish physician Juan Huarte and his theory of *ingenio* as a generative power. Since the mind manifests itself within and through the body, Vives says, its operational activity could properly be named an engine, an ingenious device: "If we have decided to call

ingenium the whole force of our mind it is because that force only reveals and puts itself out with the attendance of instruments." (*De anima et vita*, 1538 II, 6). For Vives, *ingenium* is a cognitive process where a regime of food, lifestyle, medicines, and bodily functions are needed. This medical insight had been already partly formulated by Marsilio Ficino in his *De vita libri tres* (1489), when considering the classical question of whether melancholy among studious scholars and dedicated craftsmen (*ingeniosi*) was a physical temper or a disease (*De vita* I, V–VI). Martin Luther (1483–1546) used this physiological account of *ingenium* to explain his own therapeutic practices sharpen his wit: "I have no better remedy than anger. If I want to write, pray, or preach, then I have to be angry; then all of my blood is refreshed, my wit is sharpened (*acuitur ingenium*) and all attacks against me give way" (*Tischreden* 1531–1546, 2410b).

Cause and Effect of All Inventions

For early moderns like Ficino, Luther, and Vives, at least two core meanings may be attributed to *ingenium*: as a cause – ingenuity as a generative ability – or as an effect – ingenuity as an application or output of knowledge (Hidalgo-Serna 1983; Gensini and Martone 2002).

In terms of action, ingenuity was primarily understood as the source of invention, thought, or engenderment and, mostly, as the ensemble of intellectual faculties (including those possessed by animals, although they were thought to lack reason). This meaning operated within a social logic in which individuals presented or described each other's points of view and manners (good or bad) in terms of "ingenious" performance. Indeed, the language of ingenuity is present in courtly, artistic, and scholarly competition for reputation and patronage (Zilsel 1926). In his *Vite* (1550), Giorgio Vasari used *ingegno* to label exceptional-ity and vivacity of spirit, strength of character, and a particular talent in action exerted by the *artefice del disegno* (Zagoury 2018). The notion became a term that served to render the inventive act of the arts intelligible (Baxandall 1971, 17). For Italian poets, chroniclers, and humanists, the rhetoric of *ingegno* involved an earthbound, engaged



Genius, as *ingenium*, Fig. 3 Frontispiece from W. H. Ryff, *Architectur*, Nuremberg: Petreius, 1547. An allegory of mathematics being weighed down by a purse representing the hindrance of *ingenium* by poverty or worldly concerns. The putto is adapted from Andrea Alciato's emblem "Pauertatem summis ingeniis obesse ne provehantur" (Poverty hinders the greatest talents from advancing). The objects around represent the mathematical and mechanical arts. The plate is accompanied by two inscriptions: "Vivitur ingenio, caetera mortis erunt" (we live by the spirit, the rest belongs to death) and "Aurum probatur igni ingenium vero Mathematicis" (Just as gold is proved by fire, so true intelligence is shown by mathematics). (<https://doi.org/10.17863/CAM.45667>)

alternative to the disembodied ideals of metaphysics, logics, and grammar lessons (Grassi 1994, 2001) *Ingenium* was taken as the ability of conceiving, ordering, and delivering ideas, images, and arguments. This is why the young Descartes, in his *Regulae ad directionem ingenii* (ca. 1628), was keen to explore means of orientating and training the *ingenium* in the pursuit of truth. For rhetoricians and moral philosophers, like

Emanuele Tesauro in his *Il cannocchiale aristotelico* (1654), the cognitive ability of seeing the common in diversity when making metaphors and creating symbols and *concetti* was held to be the revelatory sign of someone's witty spirit (Hersant 2001; Blanco 1992). At the end of the seventeenth century, Giambattista Vico received this robust tradition in the scholarly milieu of Naples and defined *ingenium* as the source of philosophical *eloquenza* and the faculty of assembling that which at first sight appears to be separate and unrelated (Vico, *De antiquissima italorum sapientia*, I, VII, 4). This capacity to gather the common was for him the source of knowledge *tout court*. Here, Vico drew on Aristotelian "εὐφροῖα" understood as the capacity to see the similar and convey it through metaphors (*Poetics*, 1459a 5–7).

The second core meaning of *ingenium* construed it as an effect. In this metonymic sense, shifting from cause to effect, from inward conception to the realization of an outcome, the word *ingenium* could be applied to all sorts of productions in the realm of engineers, artisans, and machine-minders (Oosterhoff et al. 2020). This extended use of ingenuity is conveyed by Vives with the example of craftsmen, who are connected to their work through the means and operations that they use (*De anima et vita libri tres* 1543, I, XII, 62). Instantiations of ingenuity were inventions such as automata, instruments of war, machines, and fireworks, as well as diagrams, paintings, sculptures, buildings, puns, and witty concepts (*concetti*) (Sawday 2007). Instruments, applications, and results can be understood as organically linked to the intellectual act of their design. In connection with this, the figure of the engineer as the master of the "science of ingenuity" should be highlighted.

The engineer grew in stature in Europe within royal institutions of natural philosophy, mechanics, and geometry, such as Louis XIV's *Académie Royale des Sciences* (Vérin 1993). Since medieval times, the *ingignour* or *ingeniator* was summoned by kings and princes because he was endowed with *ingenium* (dynamic mind, inventiveness) and because he produced *ingenia* (instruments and devices) for the mechanization of human



Genius, as *ingenium*, Fig. 4 *Ingegno* as a winged young archer, representing penetration, acuity, and investigation, according to Cesare Ripa, *Della novissima iconologia*, Padova: Pietro Paolo Tozzi, 1625. (<https://archive.org/details/dellanovissimaic01ripa/page/317>)

action. Particularly useful in times of war, these multipurpose artificers were called upon for tricking the enemy using finely tuned machinery. Faced with existential problems – concrete, everyday needs and crises – human *ingenium* is, in this engineering sense, conceived as the use of intelligence over strength. This sense is manifest in the Spanish and Portuguese languages, where *ingenio* and *engenho* denote productive working places for both mining and farming processes, as is the case for the *ingenios de azúcar*, industrial complexes encompassing all the procedures, people, plantations, mills, and furnaces needed to produce sugar: one of the major activities that structured the early modern Atlantic economy (Schwartz 1986).

Generative Power

The twofold semantic strand of early modern ingenuity as cause and outcome leads to a picture of reality in which, currently or potentially, all beings, operations, and phenomena can be considered as ingenious (Vélez Posada 2015). This philosophical pervasiveness of *ingenium* was conveyed by Giordano Bruno with a strong generalizing formula: ingenuity is the “*vis ingenita*,” the innate power that each being has (Canone 2006). The expansiveness of *ingenium* made the word able to denote a kind of generative economy of

nature, instantiated in different entities and not only in humans. In that sense, the culture of ingenuity must also be associated with the rise of cosmological speculations during the sixteenth and seventeenth centuries (Daston and Park 1998). It is unsurprising, therefore, that representations surrounding the notion of *ingenium* were reminiscent of one of the most prevalent metaphors in natural philosophy: *Natura Artifex*, nature as the great artisan and master.

This cosmological expansion of ingenuity when depicting the world as a restless, material agent is best illustrated by Antonio Persio’s *Trattato dell’ingegno dell’uomo* (1576). In this work, Persio praises the wealth of all inventions produced by human ingenuity. Through a hugely extensive list of such inventions, Persio creates a cosmological image of ingenuity. By following Ficino’s comments on Plato and natural philosopher Bernardino Telesio, his master, Persio ends his *Trattato* by arguing that the cosmos is a living spirit, that every part of the universe must be considered as a microcosm or a “*picciol mondo*” with ingenuity, and that each *ingenium* reveals in its own way the universal movement of solar light and spirited heat.

For this reason, it is worth noting the natural philosophical breadth ingenuity could cover in early modernity, where it was applicable to such less obviously appropriate entities as geographic regions. In his *Cosmographia Universalis* (1550), Sebastian Münster presented in the book’s title page what would become a model for geographical description. Among the aspects that he thought should be included when examining regions, Münster considered the ingenuities of the earth, the “*terrae ingenia*,” to be of great importance. With this expression, Münster repurposed the idea of *genius loci*, or spirit of the place, and gave it a more substantively physical dimension. Here, *ingenium* is used to indicate the properties of lands and commodities of places around the world, a particular terrain or, in a broad sense, the generating Earth. With the expression *terrae ingenia*, Münster highlighted the encounter of human agency with environmental agency, since the fertility of the land goes together with the art, knowledge, and industry produced within.



Genius, as *ingenium*, Fig. 5 Portrait of the humanist scholar Willibald Pirckheimer from Nuremberg, by Albrecht Dürer in 1524. Dürer gave this portrait to his best friend, here praise by his *ingenium* which will live on beyond death. (<https://www.metmuseum.org/art/collection/search/391286>)

Juan Huarte de San Juan's *Examen de ingenios* (1575 and 1594) is certainly the fullest early-modern exploration of the natural philosophical dimensions of *ingenium*. According to the Spanish physician, the term *ingenio* contained an illuminating, subtle philosophical insight for his time. For Huarte, the notion of *ingenio* captures a common, distributed generative power (*potencia generativa*) in animals, plants, and humans, as well as in God and angels (Huarte 1989, 187). Huarte suggests that human nature has a tendency toward engenderment that can take place through reproduction, nutrition, growth, movement, and sensation or by means of thought within the sciences and arts (Huarte 1989, I). Huarte's explanation of knowledge-making in terms of embodied generative powers is one of his significant

philosophical contributions. Huarte provides account in which ingenuity follows the body's flow, its growth and decline, along with other functions such as digestion, blood making, and sexual desire (Velez Posada 2021).

Human Diversity and the Politics of Ingenuity

Since the mid-fifteenth century, Portuguese and Spanish expansion had brought to humanist culture information about different abilities and ways of living from people inhabiting regions that were previously little known or unknown by Europeans. The manifest diversity among populations in Asia, Africa, and the New World occasioned debates on human rationality in which ingenuity played a prominent role. *Ingenium* appeared not only as a token to reveal singular ways of living in particular places but, most crucially, to reveal the common, creative rationality between cultures: an "artistic humanity" based on a distributed and diverse *ingenium* (Russo 2015). Within the European humanistic tradition, a strong argument for both the unity and diversity of human beings was their ingenious comportments and capacities that were manifest in learning and making. Aesthetic and moral accounts in which *ingenium* was used to describe people from non-European regions abound in early reports from Spanish authorities in the Americas.

In 1537, the Dominican Julián Garcés, at the time the bishop of Tlaxcala in New Spain, wrote an apologetic letter to Pope Paul III describing the Tlaxcala inhabitants' strength of spirit (*vigor de espíritu*), their lively understanding (*viveza de entendimiento*), their good nature (*buen natural*), their handicraft (*obras de mano*), and, in brief, the clarity, promptness, and facility of their wits (*claridad, presteza y facilidad de ingenios*) (García 1907, CXII 244). This letter seems to have had an important political impact. A few months later, Pope Paul III issued the bull *Sublimis Deus* in which, by acknowledging the rationality of the Amerindian population, slavery and plunder in imperial expansions were condemned. The effect of these defenses of the New World's ingenuity gained imperial implications with the introduction in 1542 of *Las Nuevas Leyes* (the New Laws), which sought to protect indigenous people. This is the context for situating the

position of Bartolomé de Las Casas, one of the most well-known advocates in Europe for Amerindians' freedom and facility of wits (Pagden 1982). Between 1550 and 1580, hundreds of indigenous people who were enslaved and forced to relocate in the Kingdom of Castile pursued lawsuits in order to claim their right to be free and their desire to come back home. In their litigation, they used to make three interrelated claims: "that they were free by birth (*de su nacimiento*), that they were free by their nativeness (*naturaleza*) based on their place of origin; and that they were free by their *ingenio*" (Van Deusen 2015, 119). This legal and anthropological instantiation demonstrates the extent to which early modern *ingenium* was also present in political arenas, with palpable impact on social and cultural life.

Despite the fact *ingenium* was widely recognized and described as being an industrious, creative, diverse, and plural trait of humanity, hierarchies of wits were often endorsed and applied to nations, professions, and disciplines. In the end, *ingenium* was both a moral and a political tool. In the conclusion to his *Cosmographia Universalis*, Münster offers a synthesis of the global polemics between human wits (*ingenia*). For the cosmographer, there is no need to marvel:

Human populations have different fortunes, different tempers (*natura*) and different ways of life (*mores et vivendi ritus*). And because they inhabit a varied range of regions and places they can be milk-colored (*lacteos*), less white (*subalbidos*), dark (*fuscus*) and others completely burnt (*prorsus adustus*). This is how God has established it: like all other things, human beings are born with different ingenuity, mindset and industriousness (*varii ingenii et multiformis animi ac industria*). Each one is happy with his own fate and, consequently, disapproves of the situation, appearance and fortune of those who are not like him (1550, 1163).

Cross-References

- ▶ [Aesthetics](#)
- ▶ [Artisans and Artisanal Knowledge](#)
- ▶ [Artists](#)

- ▶ [Automata](#)
- ▶ [Complexion \(cf. Temperament\)](#)
- ▶ [Dead Forces and Live Forces](#)
- ▶ [Early Modern Conceptions of Distributed Cognition](#)
- ▶ [Early Modern Conceptions of Embodiment](#)
- ▶ [Engineers](#)
- ▶ [Generation Theory](#)
- ▶ [Genius, and Inspiration](#)
- ▶ [Human Diversity](#)
- ▶ [Imagination](#)
- ▶ [Intellect](#)
- ▶ [Judgment](#)
- ▶ [Knowledge](#)
- ▶ [Mechanical Work](#)
- ▶ [Medical Humanism](#)
- ▶ [Medicine in Early Modern Philosophy: An Introduction](#)
- ▶ [Melancholia](#)
- ▶ [Mental Faculties](#)
- ▶ [Mind](#)
- ▶ [Mind, and Cognition](#)
- ▶ [Natural and artificial](#)
- ▶ [Nature and Immortality of the Soul](#)
- ▶ [Philosophical Transactions](#)
- ▶ [Reason and Rationality](#)
- ▶ [Rhetoric and Psychology](#)
- ▶ [Technique](#)

References

- Baxandall M (1971) Giotto and the Orators. Humanist observers of painting in Italy and the discovery of pictorial composition 1350–1450. Oxford University Press, Oxford
- Blanco M (1992) Les Rhétoriques de la Pointe: Baltasar Gracián et le Conceptisme en Europe. Champion, Paris
- Brann NL (2002) The debate over the origin of genius during the Italian Renaissance: the theories of supernatural frenzy and natural melancholy in accord and in conflict on the threshold of the scientific revolution. Brill, Leiden
- Canone E (2006) Ingegno (ingenium). In: Enciclopedia bruniana e campanelliana, vol. I, Giornate di studi 2001–2004. Istituto Editoriale e poligrafico internazionali, Pisa/Roma, pp 59–70
- Daston L, Park K (1998) Wonders and the order of nature, 1150–1750. Zone, New York/Cambridge MA
- García G (1907) Documentos inéditos o muy raros para la historia de México, vol.15. Librería de la Viuda de Charles Bouret, México

- Gensini S, Martone A (2002) *Ingenium propria hominis natura*. Liguori Editori, Naples
- Goodey CF (2011) A history of intelligence and intellectual “disability”: the shaping of psychology in early modern Europe. Ashgate, Farnham
- Grassi E (1994) The primordial metaphor. *Medieval & Renaissance Texts & Studies* in collaboration with the Italian Academy, Binghamton
- Grassi E (2001) *Rhetoric as philosophy: the humanist tradition*. Southern Illinois University Press, Carbondale
- Hersant Y (2001) *La métaphore baroque*. D’Aristote à Tesaurio. Éditions du Seuil, Paris
- Hidalgo-Serna E (1983) ‘Ingenium’ and rhetoric in the work of Vives. *Philos Rhetor* 16(4):228–241
- Hidalgo-Serna E (1993) *El pensamiento ingenioso de Baltasar Gracián*. Anthropos, Barcelona
- Huarte J (1989) *Examen de ingenios para las ciencias* (ed: Serés G). Cátedra, Madrid
- Lecointe J (1993) *L’idéal et la différence: la perception de la personnalité littéraire à la Renaissance*. Librairie Droz, Geneva
- Marr A (2015) Pregnant wit: ingegno in Renaissance England. *Br Art Stud* 1. <https://doi.org/10.17658/issn.2058-5462/issue-01/amarr>. Accessed 10 Oct 2019
- Marr A, Garrod R, Marcaida JR, Oosterhoff RJ (2018) *Logodaedalus: word histories of ingenuity in early modern Europe*. Pittsburgh University Press, Pittsburgh
- Marr A, Cacho Casal M, Colville T, Galandra Cooper I, Vélez Posada A (2019) Ingenious images: a catalogue of the visual culture of early modern ingenuity. <https://www.repository.cam.ac.uk/handle/1810/294137>. Accessed 10 Oct 2019
- Oosterhoff R J, Marcaida J R, Marr A (2020) *Ingenuity in the making: matter and technique in early modern Europe*. University of Pittsburgh Press, Pittsburgh. [forthcoming]
- Pagden A (1982) *The fall of natural man: the American Indian and the origins of comparative ethnology*. Cambridge University Press, Cambridge
- Russo A (2015) An artistic humanity: new positions on art and freedom in the context of Iberian expansion, 1500–1600. *Res Anthropol Aesthet* 65–66:352–363
- Sawday J (2007) *Engines of the imagination: Renaissance culture and the rise of the machine*. Routledge, London
- Schwartz SB (1986) *Sugar plantations in the formation of Brazilian society: Bahia, 1550–1835*. Cambridge University Press, Cambridge
- Shapin S, Schaffer S (1985) *Leviathan and the air-pump: Hobbes, Boyle, and the experimental life*. Princeton University Press, Princeton
- Van Deusen NE (2015) *Global indios: the indigenous struggle for justice in sixteenth-century Spain*. Duke University Press, Durham/London
- Vélez Posada A (2015) *Irradiaciones del ingenium. Representaciones cosmológicas y poder generativo de la naturaleza durante el Renacimiento*. *Co-herencia* 12(23):233–262
- Vélez Posada A (2021) *Generative powers. Juan Huarte de San Juan and Early Modern Ingenuity*. University of Pittsburgh Press, Pittsburgh [Forthcoming]
- Vérin H (1993) *La gloire des ingénieurs. L’intelligence technique du XVème au XVIIIème siècle*. Albin Michel, Paris
- Zagoury D (2018) Minerva in the forge of Vulcan: ingegno, fatica and imagination in early Florentine art theory. In: Lüthy C, Bakker P, Swan C, Zittel C (eds) *Image, imagination, and cognition: medieval and early modern theory and practice*. Brill, Leiden, pp 61–93
- Zilsel E (1926) *Die Entstehung des Geniebegriffes: ein Beitrag zur Ideengeschichte der Antike und des Frühkapitalismus*. Mohr, Tübingen